The Morse Code Protest Ear Warmer:
FUCK ICE Textured Motif

Materials:

- Worsted Weight Yarn
- Scissors
- Yarn Needle
- Size US6/4mm circular or double pointed needles (Or whatever size needed to hit gauge)

Gauge:

4x4" swatch (10x10cm) = 26 stitches wide, 32 rows tall

Dimensions:

10.5in wide, 3.25in tall

Notes:

- This pattern was designed using a head measurement of 21in with a negative ease of 2in. If you have a larger or smaller head circumference the pattern can be very easily adapted by casting on more or fewer stitches and adjusting the non-charted section of the headband. When I tell you in the pattern to place markers to identify where the motif will be, just make sure to evenly distribute any width changes on either side of the motif section (56 stitches)

Introduction:

This is the Morse Code Protest Ear Warmer. The knit/purl texture of this pattern spells FUCK ICE in Morse Code. ***This pattern is available for free but with a suggested donation to any of the following causes to support the resistance against the cruel and inhumane treatment of civilians by ICE, support for legal funds of detained individuals, and/or general civil liberties protections.***

Immigrant Defense Project: https://www.immigrantdefenseproject.org/donate/
National Immigrant Justice Center: https://immigrantjustice.org/ways-to-help/
National Immigration Law Center: https://www.nilc.org/action/
Stand with Minnesota: https://www.standwithminnesota.com/
The American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU): https://www.aclu.org/issues/immigrants-rights

Will knitting a headband cause meaningful change? No, of course not. BUT, fiber arts have a deep and rich history in resistance spaces. I chose to use morse code for this pattern because it is well documented that women often used knitting patterns during WWII with morse code motifs to send messages in resistance of the Nazi regime. This pattern is not designed to be a single act of resistance – it is designed to be a fundraising opportunity, a way to channel the collective rage and heartbreak of the current

environment into something beautiful and still relevant, and as a way to educate people on the history of fiber arts being used in generations of resistance against fascism. Knit the headband, but please do not let it be the only thing you do. It is our responsibility as a collective to take as much action as we can against the injustices we are seeing in our communities. Write and call your representatives, donate money, show up where and when you can. Thank you!

Pattern:

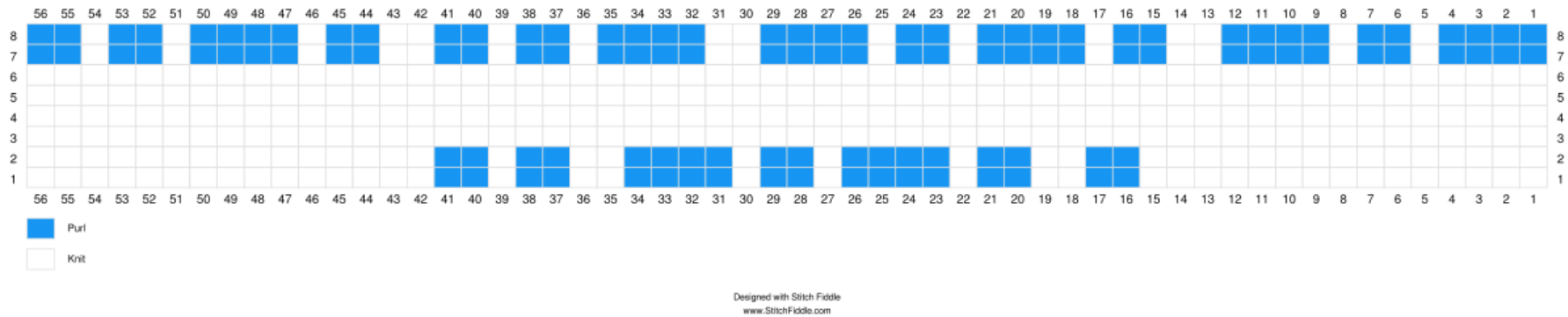
Cast on 121 stitches onto 4mm circular or double pointed needles using your preferred method. Sample uses a long tail cast on. To join the work in the round, place your BOR marker, knit the first stitch then cast off the last cast on stitch over that first knit stitch (you will now have 120 stitches on your needle).

Rows 1-5: Work in 1x1 rib (k1, p1 around)
(F*irst knit stitch is already worked when joining in the round if following instructions above)*
Row 6: Purl all stitches around
Rows 7-10: Knit all stitches around
Row 11: Knit 32 stitches, place marker, knit 56 stitches, place marker, knit 32 stitches. If adjusting pattern for head circumference, adjust the number of stitches equally on either side of the motif section (54 stitches used for the motif).
Rows 12-13: Knit to first marker, work in motif chart pattern until 2nd marker, then knit to end of round
Rows 14-17: Knit all stitches around (*reflected in white section of the motif pattern*)
Rows 18-19: Knit to first marker, work in motif chart pattern until 2nd marker, then knit to end of round
Rows 20-24: Knit all stitches around
Row 25: Purl all stitches around
Rows 26-30: Work in 1x1 rib (k1, p1 around)

Bind off in preferred method. Sample uses an Italian bind off worked without rows of double knitting.

Link to editable version of the motif chart in Stitch Fiddle: https://www.stitchfiddle.com/c/sgiwc3-7he1hk

Motif Chart:



Adaptations for colorwork motif:

If you'd like to work the motif in colorwork rather than textured stitches, you have a few options:

1. Work the entire headband flat instead of in the round (cast on 1 fewer stitch at the beginning) and use intarsia for the colorwork chart
2. Work the headband in the round and use stranded colorwork, catching floats every 2-4 stitches around the non-motif section of the work
3. Work in the round and perform German Short Row turns during the motif section to work an intarsia-style colorwork. For this method I worked the first colorwork row as normal, then when I got to the end of the round performed the GSR turn, then worked the 2nd row of the motif purlwise. Then when reaching the other end of the round, perform a 2nd GSR turn to work back knitwise. Repeat pattern for the 2nd motif section.